

Mythology/Hist. Fiction





About the Course

Students read Norse mythology for a term, enjoy a term of fairy tales from around the world collected or written in the 19th century, and finish with a term of African American folktales.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 4

About Literature: Grade 4

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

About Literature: Grade 4

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

Can easily be combined with students in Grades 3 or 5.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4	Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 1 time/week 20 min	In the Days of Giants Russian Fairy Tales South American Jungle Tales The Tales of Uncle Remus: The Adventures of Brer Rabbit Short Stories & Folktales

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 4				
	General Lit.: Grade 4		Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

In the Days of Giants tells the stories of Norse mythology and is read in Terms 1-2. The Nordic

people would enjoy telling tales of heroes, gods, and monsters during the long, dark winter nights. As such, we recommend teachers preview the readings to ensure they are suitable for their particular students.

Term 2 (Folk Tales): Older Folk Tales often include content such as drinking, smoking, abuse of others, etc. The teacher should preview the tales if this might be an issue for your home or classroom.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4



In the Days of Giants



Russian Fairy Tales



South American Jungle Tales



The Tales of Uncle Remus: The Adventures of Brer Rabbit

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

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or scan the QR
code for links.



Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students start reading independently (General Literature selections are especially good for independent work).



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them an illustration, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas

in the manner most natural to them.

- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time might be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

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Term 1

WEEK 1 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants, Student World Atlas

→ INTRO

We will be reading Norse mythology. It is a series of beliefs and legends belonging to Scandinavian people who lived in modern-day Norway, Sweden, and Denmark. The Nordic people would enjoy telling tales of heroes, gods, and monsters during the long, dark winter nights.

→ LOCATE

Find Scandinavian countries of today: Denmark, Norway, Sweden

☐ Map Resource: Student World Atlas

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Beginning of Things" and "How Odin Lost His Eye" p.9-16

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Kvasir's Blood" p.17-22

WEEK 3 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Giant Builder" p.23-28

WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 4

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Magic Apples" p.29-38

★ TEACHER TIP

This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or next lesson (which is shorter) if desired.

WEEK 5 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 5

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Skadi's Choice" p.39-42

WEEK 6 ☐ 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 6

☐ Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

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Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "The Dwarf's Gifts" p.43-51	
WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 7 Materials: In the Days of Giants → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Loki's Children" p.52-56	
WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 8 Materials: In the Days of Giants → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "The Quest of the Hammer" p.57-66	★ TEACHER TIP This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or pick up next lesson.
WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 9 Materials: In the Days of Giants → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "The Giantess Who Would Not" p.67-72	
WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 10 Materials: In the Days of Giants → RECAP What did you read last time? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Thor's Visit to the Giants" p.73-82	★ TEACHER TIP This chapter is longer. Students may finish in the afternoon or over exam week if desired.
WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 11 Materials: In the Days of Giants → RECAP What do you remember from this book from earlier this year? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Thor's Fishing" p.83-90	
WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: In the Days of Giants	

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

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Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 13

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Thor's Duel" p.91-97

WEEK 2 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 14

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"In the Giant's House" p.98-105

WEEK 3 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 15

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Balder and the Mistletoe" p.106-113

WEEK 4 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 16

Materials: In the Days of Giants

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Punishment of Loki" p.114-121

WEEK 5 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 17

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ INTRO

For centuries, people shared stories out loud around fires, at celebrations, and before bed. By the 1800s, many people worried these beloved tales were disappearing as the world rapidly changed around them, so collectors began writing them down. The Brothers Grimm gathered folk tales across Germany, Hans Christian Andersen turned Danish traditions into fairy tales, and Andrew Lang collected stories from countries all over the world. In America, people began recording the stories of Indigenous communities and formerly enslaved people. Now it's your turn to explore these timeless tales and discover the stories people have treasured for generations. We'll start our journey in South America with a tale about a lazy bee.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Lazy Bee" Read from the beginning to "inside a hollow tree."

- What do you think will happen next?

→ MAP WORK

★ TEACHER NOTE

The world of folk tales is vast. Explore extra helpings for other tales to include or substitute as desired. For instance, Favorite African Folk Tales by Nelson Mandela features many short tales that could easily be added to a lesson or enjoyed as a read-aloud.

Note that a Christmas tale is in the final two lessons of the term. Feel free to swap around the order of the tales if needed to read that story closer to Christmas.

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Term 2

Find the continent of South America on a map or globe. Our first tale takes place in the country of Argentina. See if you can find Argentina on your map. (The story mentioned the city of Misiones. Misiones is actually not a city, but is one of the provinces of Argentina.)

WEEK 6 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 18

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ RECAP

What happened to the little bee in the first part of the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Lazy Bee" - Read "And now the little bee" to the end of the story.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Sensitive Plant

- What was the lesson the little bee learned? Do you agree?

WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 19

Materials: South American Jungle Tales

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The Giant Tortoise's Golden Rule"

- What was the moral or lesson in this story?

→ MAPWORK

Our last tale took place in the South American country of Argentina. This tale includes a man from Buenos Aires, which is the capital city of Argentina. See if you can find Buenos Aires on a map.

WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 20

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ INTRO

Our next tales come from Russia. Russia is a vast land with a rich culture full of art, music, poetry, and storytelling stretching back hundreds of years. Its folk tales offer a window into a culture that loved nature, prized humility, and understood that life held both joy and hardship. Heroes in these stories are often humble and kind rather than powerful and proud, and magic is woven naturally into the everyday world. As you read, remember that you are not just enjoying a good story, but catching a glimpse of a way of life.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tsar Sultan: Read from the beginning to "written in a tale."

- Does this fairy tale remind you of any others you have heard?

→ MAPWORK

Find Russia on a map. The land occupied by Russia has changed over many years. In the 1800's, Russia even owned the land that is now the state of Alaska. Russia sold Alaska to the United States in 1867, though it didn't become a state until almost 100 years later, in 1959.

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Term 2

WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 21

Materials: Russian Fairy Tales

→ RECAP

What has happened to the Tsaritsa and her son so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tsar Sultan: Read "They entered it" to the end of the tale.

- What part of the tale was most surprising to you? Most interesting? Why?

• EXTRA HELPING

The George MacDonald Christmas Collection is a good choice if you'd like to substitute a tale during the Christmas season.

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 22

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ INTRO

George MacDonald was a Scottish storyteller (1823-1905). He loved fairy tales and fantasy, and even inspired C.S. Lewis, who wrote The Chronicles of Narnia! MacDonald was a devoted Christian, and his faith showed in his writing. He loved Christmas so much that he would carol through the streets with his children and sometimes invite over a hundred strangers into his home to celebrate! He wrote Christmas poems, songs, and stories to share that joy with others. Today you're going to read one of his Christmas stories called "Papa's Story" (sometimes called "A Scot's Christmas"). In it, a father tells his children a tale on Christmas Eve. As you read, think about what lessons might be hiding inside, just like the other tales we have read.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

p.40-48 til "He soon fell asleep."

∞ Link: "Papa's Christmas Story"

- What do you think Nelly has made up her mind to do?

→ MAPWORK (OPTIONAL)

This tale takes place in Scotland. Find Scotland on a map or globe.

★ TEACHER NOTE

This story can be borrowed on Internet Archive and is also available in this book under the title "Papa's Story."

∞ Link: George MacDonald Christmas Collection

There is a mention of drinking alcohol in the assigned reading.

WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 23

Materials: "Papa's Christmas Story" (aka A Scot's Christmas Story) by George MacDonald

→ RECAP

What did Nelly dream about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48 "When Nelly thought" - p.60 (end of story)

- Did this story remind you of a Bible story you have heard before? If so, how are they alike and different?
- Why do you think MacDonald chose to tell this kind of story at Christmas? What does it have to do with the meaning of the holiday?

→ MAPWORK

Nelly traveled to Edinburgh, which is the capital city of Scotland. See if you can find Edinburgh on a map.

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Term 2

WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Folk Tales from lessons

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

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Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 25

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

PREP: For history and context on this collection of Brer Rabbit tales and their broader relevance, read Julius Lester's Foreword on p.xiii-xxi.

→ INTRO

Many different stories were published and told in the 1700s. Some stories that became increasingly popular were about a rabbit. A rabbit is the main character in many folktales from Africa, and as more and more people in Africa were enslaved and brought to the American colonies, "...they took stories from home about a hare – Wakaima – and adapted them to their new surroundings" (viii). Over time, a new set of stories developed about a rabbit, now named Brer Rabbit, through this interaction of cultures from Africa, America, and the West Indies. The stories were told aloud and changed depending on the storyteller and the listener, so while they are old stories, they are also new every time they are told.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.4-10 "How Brer Fox and Brer Dog Became Enemies," "Hold'im Down, Brer Fox," "Brer Rabbit Comes to Dinner"

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is an audiobook version of these tales read by the author, which is a great option to give students a bit more independence and allow them to experience the stories orally. Note that only selections of the book are included in the lesson plans. Some of the omitted stories have content you might want to preview before allowing students to listen to the whole book.

WEEK 2 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 26

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ INTRO

Who would you expect to win a contest or a fight between a rabbit and a fox?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.16-23 "Brer Rabbit Gets Even"

WEEK 3 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 27

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-31 "Brer Turtle, Brer Rabbit, and Brer Fox" and "Brer Wolf Tries to Catch Brer Rabbit"

- Were you worried Brer Rabbit might not get away this time?

WEEK 4 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 28

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus and painting/drawing supplies

→ INTRO

If you have heard it before, tell what you remember about the story of the turtle racing the hare. Today's story is a different version of it!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.31-34 "Brer Rabbit Finally Gets Beaten"

- What did you think of the story?
- How was Brer Turtle the perfect match for Brer Rabbit?

→ ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint an illustration to go with today's story!

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Term 3

WEEK 5 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 29

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.42-43 "Brer Fox and Brer Rabbit Go Hunting"

p.46-50 "Brer Rabbit Eats the Butter"

- What do you think Brer Fox meant when he said he "caught a handful of common sense"?
- What do you think about the ending of the story with Brer Rabbit and the butter? Did it surprise you? If you made up a different ending for the story, what would it be?

WEEK 6 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 30

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ INTRO

What do you think it means if I say someone is "resourceful"?

→ READ

p.54-56 "Brer Rabbit's Children"

p.60-62 "Brer Rabbit and Brer Lion"

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

Since these readings are shorter, practice giving as much detail as possible in your written or oral narrations. Tell/write the stories as if you were telling them to a friend who had never heard them before!

WEEK 7 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 31

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.68-71 "The Talking House" and "Brer Rabbit Gets Eaten Again"

p.96-99 "The Moon in the Pond"

- Have you ever seen the moon in a pond or a puddle?

→ ILLUSTRATE

With the remaining time, illustrate a scene from one of today's stories.

WEEK 8 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 32

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.99-101 "Why Brer Bear Has No Tail"

p.104-106 "Brer Rabbit Gets the Money"

- If you made up a Brer Rabbit story, what would it be about? Maybe try making one up this week!

WEEK 9 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 33

Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.113-115 "The Noise in the Woods"

p.122-124 "Brer Rabbit Tells on Brer Wolf"

Term 3	
• What things do you admire or like about Brer Rabbit? What things do you think he does that are wrong?	
WEEK 10 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 34 Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus → INTRO One of our stories today is called "How Brer Rabbit Became a Scary Monster." What do you think is going to happen? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS p.127-131 "How Brer Rabbit Became a Scary Monster" p.137-141 "Brer Rabbit Outwits Mr. Man"	
WEEK 11 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 35 Catch Up Materials: Tales of Uncle Remus → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 20m Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4 - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Tales of Uncle Remus	

Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4

Examination

- Term 1** · In the Days of Giants: Give a short account of one of Odin's or Loki's adventures using words or pictures.
- Term 2** · Tell about a favorite fairy or folk tale you read this term and what lesson or moral the tale was trying to share.
- Why do tales from different countries and cultures have things in common with each other? Give some examples of similar tales.
- Term 3** · Tales of Uncle Remus: Tell the story of Brer Rabbit and Brer Turtle OR tell a story about Brer Rabbit and Brer Fox.